FLE TRIBE

WEEK 09 · WEDNESDAY · LESSON GUIDE

Loading, error & empty states

This week: Fetch live data from an API and show it with loading, error and empty states.

Four states, every time

- **Loading**: the request is on its way. Show a spinner or a grey placeholder.
- **Success**: show the data.
- **Empty**: it worked, but there's nothing to show. Say so and suggest what to do.
- **Error**: say what went wrong in plain words and offer "Try again".

In code

```
async function loadWeather(city) {
  show('loading');
  try {
    const res = await fetch(url(city));
    if (!res.ok) throw new Error('Request failed');
    const data = await res.json();
    data ? show('success', data) : show('empty');
  } catch {
    show('error', "Couldn't load the weather. Check your connection and try again.");
  }
}
```

Test it

In DevTools → Network, set throttling to **Slow 3G** to see your loading state, and **Offline** to see your error state.

Research questions

Answer these in the app, in your own words, to unlock the next lesson.

1. Design the four states for a weather app before writing code.
2. Throttle your network to Slow 3G. What does your app show?

Start your research here

- **Chrome DevTools: throttling**: https://developer.chrome.com/docs/devtools/network#throttle